

Word family: **unfair / unfairly / unfairness / fair / fairly**

Base word: unfair

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**

Related forms:

* **unfair** (adj.) — 不公平的；不公正的

* **unfairly** (adv.) — 不公平地；不公正地

* **unfairness** (n.) — 不公平；不公正

* **fair** (adj.) — 公平的；合理的

* **fairly** (adv.) — 公平地；相當；頗為

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **treat someone unfairly**

* **blame someone unfairly**

* **judge someone unfairly**

* **be unfair to someone**

* **an unfair decision**

* **an unfair advantage**

* **an unfair comparison**

* **unfair treatment**

* **unfair criticism**

* **unfair competition**

* **unfairness in the system**

* **fairly treated**

* **fair and unfair**

* **That's unfair.**

Meaning in this passage

> Kevin apologised to me because he had blamed me **unfairly** for delaying the project.

Here, **unfairly** means:

in a way that was not just or reasonable because the speaker was blamed without proper evidence — 不公平地；不公正地

Kevin blamed the speaker even though the speaker had actually uploaded the work. So the accusation was not based on the full facts.

中文翻譯：

Kevin 之所以向我道歉，是因為他曾經**不公平地**怪責我拖慢了小組進度。

So here:

unfairly = 沒有根據公平、合理或完整事實去對待或判斷某人

1. **unfairly (不公平地；不公正地) — 不公平地**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He had blamed me **unfairly**.

他曾經**不公平地**怪責我。

Practice 2

> She felt that she had been treated **unfairly**.

她覺得自己受到**不公平對待**。

Practice 3

> The teacher was accused of judging the students **unfairly**.

老師被指**不公平地**評價學生。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unfairly = 以不公正、不合理或沒有給予應有公平待遇的方式****

2. **treat someone unfairly — 不公平地對待某人**

Practice 1

> Nobody should be **treated unfairly** because of a misunderstanding.

任何人都都不應因誤會而受到**不公平對待**。

Practice 2

> He felt the company had **treated him unfairly**.

他覺得公司**不公平地對待他**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****treat someone unfairly = 給某人的待遇不合理、不平等或不公正****

3. ****blame someone unfairly — 不公平地怪責某人****

Practice 1

> Kevin ****blamed me unfairly**** for the delay.

Kevin 因延誤而****不公平地怪責我****。

Practice 2

> Don't ****blame someone unfairly**** before checking the facts.

未查清楚事實前，不要****不公平地怪責別人****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****blame someone unfairly = 在責任未明或證據不足時，把錯誤責任歸到某人身上****

4. ****judge someone unfairly — 不公平地判斷某人****

Practice 1

> We shouldn't ****judge people unfairly**** based on one mistake.

我們不應因一個錯誤就****不公平地評價別人****。

Practice 2

> She felt she had been ****judged unfairly****.

她覺得自己受到****不公平評價****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****judge someone unfairly = 沒有根據完整事實或公平標準去評價某人****

5. **unfair** (不公平的 ; 不公正的) — 不公平的

Core adjective.

Practice 1

> That was an **unfair accusation**.

那是一項**不公平的指責**。

Practice 2

> The decision seemed **unfair**.

那個決定看起來很**不公平**。

MCQ-ready definition:

unfair = 不符合公平、合理或公正原則的

6. **be unfair to someone** — 對某人不公平

Practice 1

> It was **unfair to me** to assume I had done nothing.

在沒有查清楚前認定我甚麼都沒做，對我來說很**不公平**。

Practice 2

> Don't be **unfair to your teammate**.

不要**不公平地對待你的隊友**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be unfair to someone = 對某人的待遇、判斷或要求不公正

7. **That's unfair.** — 這不公平

Practice 1

> "You have to do all the work."

> "That's **unfair**."

「所有工作都要你做。」

「這太**不公平**了。」

Practice 2

> I think the punishment is **unfair**.

我覺得這個處分**不公平**。

MCQ-ready definition:

That's unfair = 表示某個安排、待遇或決定不合理或不公正

8. **unfair treatment — 不公平待遇**

Practice 1

> Employees complained about **unfair treatment**.

員工投訴受到**不公平待遇**。

Practice 2

> The policy led to **unfair treatment** of some applicants.

政策令部分申請人受到**不公平對待**。

MCQ-ready definition:

unfair treatment = 某人沒有獲得應有的公平和合理待遇

9. **unfair criticism — 不公平的批評**

Practice 1

> She received a lot of **unfair criticism**.

她受到很多**不公平的批評**。

Practice 2

> The article contained some **unfair criticism** of the team.

文章對團隊有一些**不公平的批評**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unfair criticism = 缺乏合理根據、過度或不符合實際情況的批評****

10. ****unfair accusation — 不公平 / 無理的指責****

Very relevant to your passage.

Practice 1

> Kevin's comment felt like an ****unfair accusation****.

Kevin 的說話像是一項****無理指責****。

Practice 2

> He apologized for making an ****unfair accusation****.

他為作出****不公平的指責****而道歉。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unfair accusation = 沒有充分根據、錯誤或不合理地指責某人****

11. ****unfair decision — 不公平的決定****

Practice 1

> The students protested against the ****unfair decision****.

學生抗議那項****不公平的決定****。

Practice 2

> She believed the result was based on an ****unfair decision****.

她認為結果來自一個****不公正的決定****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unfair decision = 沒有按合理或公正標準作出的決定****

12. ****unfair advantage — 不公平優勢****

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

> The rule gave one team an ****unfair advantage****.

這項規則給其中一隊帶來****不公平優勢****。

Practice 2

> Using hidden information would give you an ****unfair advantage****.

使用內幕資料會給你帶來****不公平的優勢****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unfair advantage = 因不平等、不正當或特殊待遇而得到的額外優勢****

13. ****unfair comparison — 不公平 / 不恰當的比較****

Practice 1

> Comparing a beginner with an expert is an ****unfair comparison****.

把初學者和專家比較是一個****不公平的比較****。

Practice 2

> That's an ****unfair comparison**** because the situations are different.

那個比較****不公允****，因為兩個情況不同。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unfair comparison = 因比較基礎不同或忽略重要差異而不合理的比較****

14. ****unfair competition — 不公平競爭****

Practice 1

> The company complained about ****unfair competition****.

公司投訴存在**不公平競爭**。

Practice 2

> Rules are intended to prevent **unfair competition**.

規則旨在防止**不公平競爭**。

MCQ-ready definition:

unfair competition = 因不正當手段、規則不平等或市場行為而造成的不公平競爭

15. **unfairness (不公平 ; 不公正) — 不公平**

Practice 1

> She was angry at the **unfairness** of the situation.

她對那個情況的**不公平**感到憤怒。

Practice 2

> The incident exposed the **unfairness** in the system.

事件暴露了制度中的**不公平問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

unfairness = 缺乏公平、公正或合理待遇的狀態

16. **the unfairness of something — 某事的不公平之處**

Practice 1

> He finally understood the **unfairness of his accusation**.

他終於明白自己的指責有多麼**不公平**。

Practice 2

> We discussed the **unfairness of the rule**.

我們討論那項規則的**不公之處**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****the unfairness of X = X 當中不合理、不公正的部分或性質****

17. ****fair (公平的 ; 公正的) — 公平的****

The core opposite.

Practice 1

> We need a ****fair decision****.

我們需要一個****公平的決定****。

Practice 2

> Everyone deserves a ****fair chance****.

每個人都應得到****公平機會****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fair = 根據合理、公正和一致標準對待所有人****

18. ****fairly (公平地) — 公平地 ; 公正地****

Practice 1

> Everyone should be ****treated fairly****.

每個人都應受到****公平對待****。

Practice 2

> The teacher ****graded everyone fairly****.

老師****公平地****為每個人評分。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fairly = 以公正、合理、不偏袒的方式****

19. **fairly (相當 ; 頗為) — 相當 ; 頗**

A completely separate adverb sense.

Practice 1

> The task was **fairly difficult**.

那項任務**相當困難**。

Practice 2

> She speaks English **fairly well**.

她英語說得**頗好**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fairly = to a moderately high degree; quite

中文 :

相當 ; 頗為

This is a major trap because **fairly** does not always mean 「公平地」.

20. **fairly certain / fairly common — 相當肯定 / 頗常見**

Practice 1

> I'm **fairly certain** that the file was uploaded.

我**相當肯定**檔案已經上傳。

Practice 2

> This is a **fairly common** mistake.

這是一個**頗常見的錯誤**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fairly + adjective/adverb = 程度相當高 , 但通常沒有 very 那麼強

21. **fairness — 公平；公正**

Useful opposite-family noun.

Practice 1

> The decision was praised for its **fairness**.

這個決定因其**公平性**而受到讚賞。

Practice 2

> Students care about **fairness** in grading.

學生很重視評分的**公平性**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fairness = 公正、不偏袒並給予合理待遇的品質****

22. **in fairness — 公平地說；公道一點說**

A useful discourse phrase.

Practice 1

> ****In fairness to Kevin****, he apologised properly afterward.

****公平地說 / 替 Kevin 說句公道話****，他之後確實認真道歉了。

Practice 2

> ****In fairness****, everyone was under a lot of pressure.

****公道地說****，當時大家都承受很大壓力。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in fairness = 為了作出較平衡、公允的判斷而補充另一面的事實****

23. **fair enough — 有道理；可以接受**

A fixed conversational expression.

Practice 1

> "I need more time."

> "***Fair enough**."

「我需要更多時間。」

「**有道理 / 可以理解。**」

Practice 2

> **Fair enough**, but you should have told us earlier.

這可以理解，但你應該早點告訴我們。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair enough = 表示某人的理由或觀點合理、可以接受，即使你未必完全同意

Important distinction 1: **unfairly vs wrongly**

wrongly

incorrectly.

unfairly

in a way that is unjust or unreasonable.

Kevin:

> wrongly believed the file was missing

> = 他錯誤地以為檔案不在

and then:

> unfairly blamed the speaker

> = 他不公平地把責任歸到對方身上

Something can be wrong without being unfair, and unfair without being factually wrong in exactly the same way.

Important distinction 2: **unfair vs incorrect**

****incorrect****

factually wrong.

****unfair****

not just, balanced, or reasonable.

> an incorrect answer

錯誤答案

> an unfair judgment

不公平判斷

Important distinction 3: ****unfair vs unjust****

****unfair****

very common everyday word.

****unjust****

stronger/more formal, often involving justice, rights, or serious moral wrong.

> unfair criticism

不公平批評

> unjust punishment

不公正的懲罰

They overlap, but ****unjust**** often sounds weightier.

Important distinction 4: ****unfair vs biased****

****unfair****

outcome/treatment is not fair.

****biased****

judgment is systematically influenced in favor of or against someone/something.

A decision can be unfair because of bias, but unfairness may also come from carelessness or bad information.

In your passage, Kevin is ****unfair****, but we do not need to infer that he is systematically biased against the speaker.

Important distinction 5: ****unfair vs unreasonable****

****unfair****

focuses on justice/equal treatment.

****unreasonable****

focuses on lack of logic, practicality, or acceptable expectations.

> unfair blame

不公平怪責

> unreasonable deadline

不合理的期限

Important distinction 6: ****unfairly blame vs falsely accuse****

****blame unfairly****

wrongly assign responsibility.

****falsely accuse****

claim someone committed a specific wrongdoing when that claim is false.

****Falsely accuse**** can sound stronger and more serious.

In your passage, ****blame unfairly**** fits the everyday teamwork context very naturally.

Important distinction 7: **unfair treatment vs unequal treatment**

unequal

not the same.

unfair

not just.

Unequal treatment is not automatically unfair if there is a relevant reason.

So:

different ≠ necessarily unfair

Important distinction 8: **unfair advantage**

An advantage is not unfair just because one person has it.

It becomes **unfair** when it comes from:

- * unequal rules,
- * improper information,
- * cheating,
- * unjustified special treatment.

Important distinction 9: **fairly has two separate meanings**

This is one of the biggest family traps.

fairly = 公平地

> treated fairly

受到公平對待

fairly = 相當

> fairly difficult

相當困難

Do not automatically translate **fairly** as 「公平地」.

Important distinction 10: **fair vs fair enough**

fair

公平的

fair enough

「有道理 / 可以接受」

> That's fair.

那很公平。

> Fair enough.

好吧，這理由可以接受。

Not identical.

Important distinction 11: **fairness vs equality**

equality

same status/treatment/opportunity.

fairness

reasonable and just treatment.

They overlap, but fairness does not always require identical treatment.

Important distinction 12: **in fairness**

This phrase is not about physically treating someone fairly.

It is a discourse marker meaning:

如果要公道一點看 / 替對方說句公道話

It introduces balancing information.

Family-extension note

The **unfair** family centers on:

whether treatment, judgment, rules, or responsibility are just and reasonable

It branches into:

1. **adjective**

- * unfair decision
- * unfair criticism
- * unfair advantage

2. **adverb**

- * treat unfairly
- * blame unfairly

3. **noun**

- * unfairness

4. **opposite family**

- * fair
- * fairly
- * fairness

And **fairly** itself has an important separate degree meaning:

fairly difficult = 相當困難

For your passage, the exact meaning is:

unfairly = without a fair factual basis, especially by assigning responsibility before checking the evidence

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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unfairly	不公平地；不公正地	unjust manner
treat unfairly	不公平對待	unjust treatment
blame unfairly	不公平地怪責	wrongly assign blame
judge unfairly	不公平地評價	unjust judgment
unfair	不公平的	not just
be unfair to someone	對某人不公平	treatment
That's unfair	這不公平	protest injustice
unfair treatment	不公平待遇	unequal/unjust treatment
unfair criticism	不公平批評	unjust criticism
unfair accusation	無理 / 不公平指責	unsupported blame
unfair decision	不公平決定	unjust decision
unfair advantage	不公平優勢	improper advantage
unfair comparison	不公平比較	bad basis of comparison
unfair competition	不公平競爭	improper competition
unfairness	不公平；不公正	lack of fairness
fair	公平的	just
fairly (manner)	公平地	justly
fairly (degree)	相當；頗為	moderately/quite
fairness	公平性	justice
in fairness	公道地說	balanced consideration
fair enough	有道理；可以接受	reasonable

For your original sentence

> Kevin apologised to me because he had blamed me ****unfairly**** for delaying the project.

Here:

****unfairly** = Kevin 在沒有查清楚共享資料夾和檔案之前，就把拖慢進度的責任歸到我身上，因此這個責怪既不準確，也不公允

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> Kevin 之所以向我道歉，是因為他曾經****不公平地怪責我****拖慢了小組進度。

The useful distinction is:

- > **wrongly blame someone** = 錯怪某人
- > **unfairly blame someone** = 在責任歸屬上對某人不公允
- > **falsely accuse someone** = 錯誤地指控某人做了某件特定壞事

For this passage, **「不公平地怪責 / 錯怪」** captures the intended meaning most naturally.